Ijun Jang

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Research interests: LLM post-training, agentic reinforcement learning, knowledge distillation, efficient reasoning, on-device AI

EDUCATION

Seoul National University Mar 2024 – Feb 2026 · Seoul, Korea
M.S. in Data Science (Advisor: Prof. Taesup Kim)

Sungkyunkwan University Mar 2019 – Feb 2024 · Seoul, Korea
B.S. in Statistics · B.S. in Computer Science (double major)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Samsung Research, Samsung Electronics Mar 2026 – Present · Seoul, Korea
AI Engineer, AI Core Team (Post-training)

- Train LLM agents with **agentic reinforcement learning** in simulated environments for multi-turn, tool-using tasks.
- Build **synthetic data generation pipelines** that produce training tasks and data for agentic RL.
- Develop **turn-level advantage estimation** for multi-turn RL, assigning credit to individual turns rather than whole trajectories.
- Apply **on-policy distillation (OPD)** to shorten the model's reasoning length while preserving task performance.

NAVER Cloud Oct 2025 – Jan 2026 · Seoul, Korea
Research Intern, Alignment Learning Team

- Participated in the WBL project on LLM alignment.
- Extended the in-house model evaluation pipeline to support the IFEval instruction-following benchmark.

Mirae Asset Securities Dec 2022 – Jan 2023 · Seoul, Korea
Data Science Intern, Data Science Team

- Analyzed website traffic data (Google Analytics) to find the critical path to the first stock trade for newly opened accounts.

PUBLICATIONS

* equal contribution

Stable On-Policy Distillation via Adaptive Target Reformulation
Ijun Jang, Jewon Yeom, Juan Yeo, Hyunggu Lim, Taesup Kim
Findings of ACL 2026

- Mixed student logits into the teacher target to mitigate gradient explosion (forward KL) and mode collapse (reverse KL) in on-policy distillation.
- Improved GSM8K accuracy from 35.1 to 39.9 over on-policy KD, with gains on code generation and summarization.

Beyond Case Law: Evaluating Structure-Aware Retrieval and Safety in Statute-Centric Legal QA
Kyubyung Chae, Jewon Yeom, Jeongjae Park, Seunghyun Bae, **Ijun Jang**, Hyunbin Jin, Jinkwan Jang, Taesup Kim
ACL 2026

- Collected 4,437 statute articles and 942 QA pairs; stored cross-article references as a graph database for an on-premise sLLM RAG system (+2.13%p win-rate with retrieval, +6.41%p with oracle documents).

Patch-level Kernel Alignment for Self-Supervised Dense Representation Learning
Ijun Jang*, Juan Yeo*, Taesup Kim
Under review

- Post-trained pretrained ViTs by aligning patch-level feature kernels between teacher and student, with augmentations designed for dense SSL.
- State-of-the-art linear segmentation on Pascal VOC (81.8), COCO-Things (82.0), COCO-Stuff (62.2) and ADE20K (41.1) mIoU.

AWARDS

Seoul Metropolitan Government Big Data Campus Contest, 2nd Place 2023

- Crime-risk prediction by district, effectiveness analysis of security facilities, and safe-route recommendation.

Mirae Asset Big Data Festival, 1st Place 2022

- Automated ESG data extraction from report tables with an image-based table extraction model; corporate ESG grade prediction.

SKKU Software Capstone Design Contest, 1st Place 2022

- Scholarship information extraction with a BERT QA model and personalized scholarship recommendation.

SKKU PBL (Project-Based Learning) Contest, 1st Place 2022

- Built a medical information website providing information on medical investigators.

SKILLS

Languages Python, R, C/C++, SQL
Frameworks PyTorch, TensorFlow